ISSUE No.15 February 1996

Thamesmead TIMES

The Front Page
Thamesmead's Good Newsagent
MARCH 17TH IS MOTHERING SUNDAY
WE STOCK A LARGE SELECTION OF CARDS,
CONFECTIONERY AND GIFTS FOR THE OCCASION.
In a rush, don't worry, we offer a gift wrapping service
pre-packed gifts also available.
So Don't Delay Visit Us Today!
We Deliver Newspapers! • National Lottery Agent
11 JOYCE DAWSON WAY THAMESMEAD TOWN CENTRE
LONDON SE28 8RA • Tel/Fax: 0181-3107119

INSIDE:

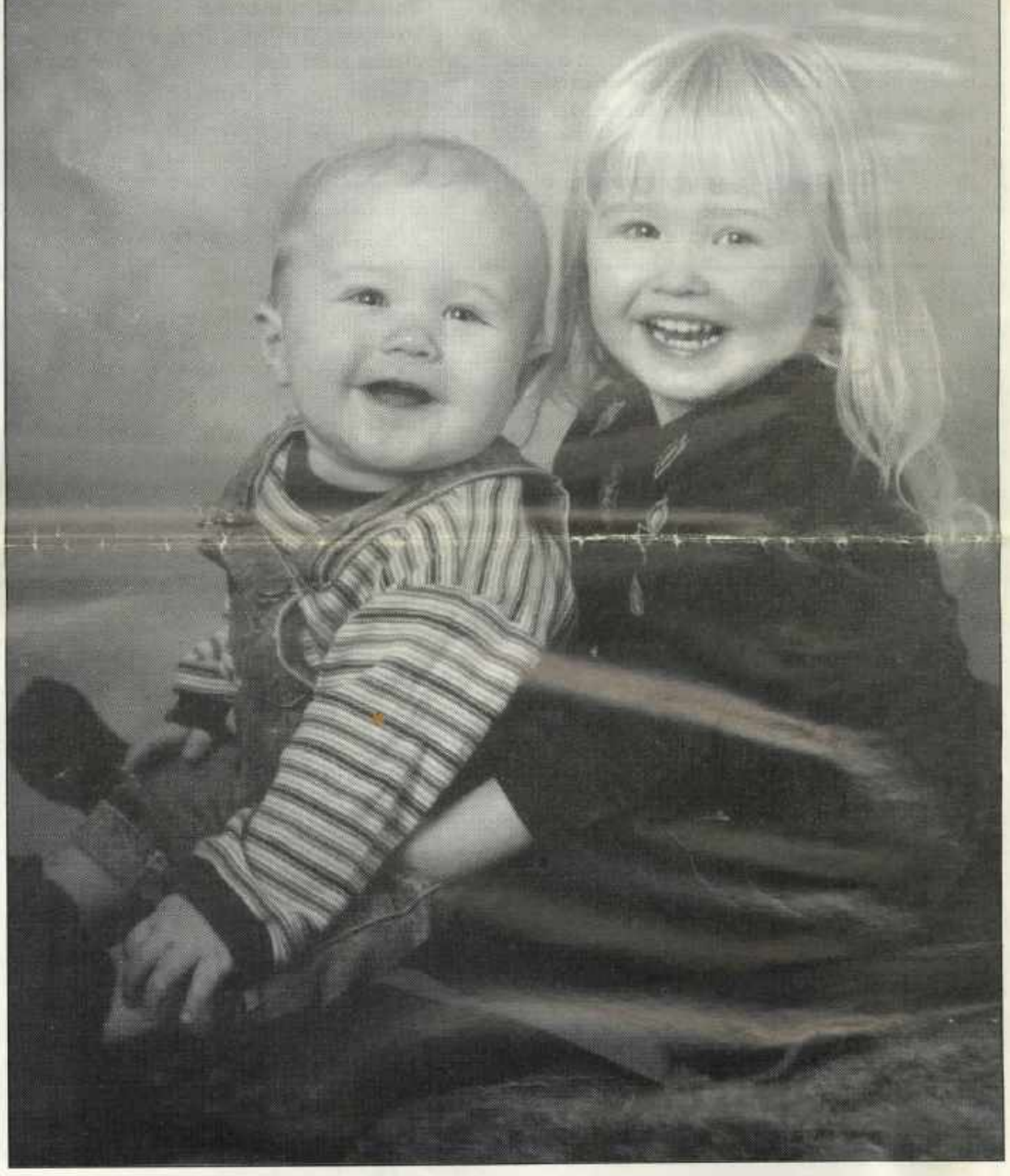
DANCE THE NIGHT AWAY WITH THE SOUL MAN (PAGE 6)
WIN TICKETS TO THE CLASSIC CAR SHOW (PAGE 7)

THAMESMEAD BUY 25 FABULOUS NEW LAKESIDE HOMES

Thamesmead Town have signed a deal with Barratt to buy 25 houses on the new development at Birchmere View as part of the plan to diversify Thamesmead's housing stock to include 'new build'.

See page 5 for report.

Could your child be Thamesmead Shopping Centre Child of the year? See page 6 for details.



Heronsgate
Dental Centre
Goosander Way
Thamesmead West
London SE28 0ER
0181 316 6313
New patients now being registered.
NHS and Private.
Kids are special to us.
Home visits for housebound.
Smile . . .
and pass it on!

Vijay Vithani's
DENTAL PRACTICE
Monday-Friday
9 am-6 pm
Late evenings and Saturdays
by appointment only.
0181-311 9400

THAMESBANK INSURANCE SERVICES
9 JOYCE DAWSON WAY THAMESMEAD
FOR THE CHEAPEST MOTOR OR CONTENTS QUOTES
RING US NOW ON
0181 311 4488
OR CALL IN AND SEE US IN THE TOWN CENTRE (OPPOSITE SAFEWAYS)
SPECIAL YOUNG DRIVERS DISCOUNTS

Thamesmead
GARAGES FOR RENT
Notice to all
Thamesmead Residents
Thamesmead Town has garages for rent throughout Thamesmead.
Rents range from £5.50 a week to £7.50 for an electronically controlled secure garage.
Why not solve that parking problem now. All you have to do is phone June Field at the Company Offices and she will send you further details and an application form.
The telephone number is 0181-310 1500 ext 268.
Harrow Manor Way,
Thamesmead South,
London SE2 9XH.
Tel: 0181-310 1500
Fax: 0181-310 1811

NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS

Greenwich Council wants to hear from women with something to contribute to making the borough a better place for the 108,600 women who make up over half its population. Women who are interested in taking part in this new initiative should contact the Council's Women's Equality Unit on 0181 312 5005/5018/5818.

Greenwich will be celebrating the fifth International Women's Week from 2nd - 10th March to highlight the diversity and achievements of women today. An exciting brochure detailing the events will be launched on 23rd February and will be available at all Leisure centres, libraries and community centres. Information is also available from the Women's Unit on 0181 854 8888 ext. 5814.

Free Help for certain householders aged 60 or over. Minor works grants are available for elderly residents, who are either home-owners, private tenants or housing association tenants in receipt of either housing benefit, council tax benefit or income support.

Grants are available to help with improvements or repairs and could include security works, smoke detectors, replacing old water heaters, new locks or energy conservation plus other similar jobs. Grants are usually up to the value of £1080 but you can have three grants of a three year period! These grants are only available for residents of Greenwich Borough. For further information contact the Housing Aid Centre, 122 Powis Street, Woolwich, SE18. Telephone 0181 854 8888 ext. 2614/2615.

Council rents in Bexley will be increased by 7.5% from April 1996. The main reasons for this are changes in the Government subsidy calculation and the need to maintain the condition of Bexley's homes. Tenants worried about their rent should ask their housing officer for advice about Housing Benefit.

Bexley Council is issuing its draft Community Care Charter for consultation. All agencies providing community care services and service users will be asked for their comments before the Charter is published on 1 April 1996.

1996 Arts Fayre. Run by the Arts Council of Bexley in their 30th Anniversary year the Annual Arts Fayre will be held at Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley over the Spring Bank Holiday on Monday 27th May 1996. For further information please telephone Suzanne Knowles, Arts Council of Bexley on 0181 309 5977.

Time to start your own business? Over the past 5 years The Business Advisory Service has helped hundreds of people start successful businesses. Call the Business Advisory Service on 0181 303 7777 ext. 4724 for further details.

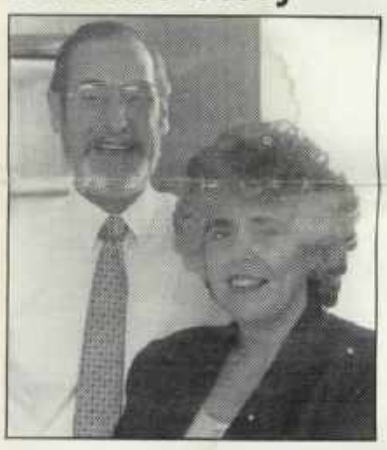
Competitive Festival for Music, Speech and Dran for 1996: At Townley Grammar School in Bexleyheath. The Speech and Drama section will cover poetry, prose and dramatic recitals, also classes for Bible Reading, original one act play writing, group and solo mime

New Horizons is looking for volunteers to befrien adults with learning disabilities living in Bexley Borough. Can you help? Phone Patricia Mount or 01322 345380.

Old footwear? Bexley Council can find them a ne home in Africa and Pakistan to benefit the less well off. Deliver them to a textile bank – there a 33 around the borough including the Waste Reception centres at Thames Road, Crayford and Foots Cray Road. For further details call: Bexley Green Line on 0181 309 7689.

Civic Recognition Award. Bexley Council is inviting nominations for its annual Award. The Council are looking for a young person under 18 years of age, who devotes time or energy to helping others. They may have had to overcome personal hurdles or disabilities, but have still managed to perform acts of service to an individual or to the community. In short, they are an example to others. For further information or a nomination form telephone 0181 303 7777 ext. 4351 or write to David Jones, Committee section, Directorate of Education, Hill View, Hill View Drive, Welling, Kent DA16 8RY. The closing date for completed nomination forms is 31 March 1996.

Thamesmead – Catering company success story



Allison Marie Catering is a success story for Thamesmead but more especially for Linda and Bert Williams who started their business from home in 1985.

Linda and Bert Williams have lived in Thamesmead for 26 years. Their first home was at Coralline Walk. Over the years they have seen many changes and now living in Parkway, they look back to the early days when the lake resembled an oversized puddle, the spine road was non existant and wildlife such as coots, pheasants, and rabbits were regular visitors.

The first Allison Marie Catering function was a wedding reception but they didn't have sufficient crockery and cutlery to cater for such a large event, their first port of call was to see their 'friendly bank manager'. They went along with a business plan, and a cheque for £42 and applied for a £1000 loan.

It was a demanding debut, but with support from neighbours, family and friends the business went from strength to strength. In spite of the recession their business grew, and they have had a successful business for 10 years.

Linda said "Thamesmead has played a very important part in our success, with a lot of our trade coming from local families and businesses. We get called back to the same families time and time again, for weddings, christenings, and sometimes funerals. We enjoy a good relationship with local businesses, catering for the smaller board receptions to conference functions. Our staff are all professionals and our reputation in catering is second to none.

Allison Marie Catering are members of The Wedding Guild.

IMPORTANT NOTICE FOR CROSSWAY RESIDENTS

Thamesmead Town has arranged a constituency meeting for Crossway residents on Monday 25 March 1996 from 7pm - 9pm at Jubilee Primary School, Crowden Way, Thamesmead North. The centre will be open from 6pm in order for residents to view a small exhibition specific to the Crossway area. Refreshments will be available free of charge before the meeting.

The Company wishes to use this opportunity to allow you to raise your concerns on general matters in the Crossway constituency and to inform you of issues and improvements affecting your area and the Company as a whole. If you have any items you wish to put on the agenda please ring the Directors Support Unit on 0181-310-1500 ext. 392. The deadline for receipt of items for the agenda is 15 March 1996.

There will be a housing desk available at this meeting from 6.30pm. This will allow residents with individual problems to speak to a housing officer in person. Individual issues will not be allowed at the main meeting.

The meeting will be attended by Mr Albert Devereux, the elected Director for Crossway and Mr Gregory Lomax, Thamesmead Town's Chief Executive.

Notes will be taken of these meetings and a report back will be made to the Board of Thamesmead Town at its next regular meeting, together with any recommendations.

PLEASE MAKE THE EFFORT TO ATTEND THESE MEETINGS - THEY ARE FOR YOUR BENEFIT.

Thamesmead congratulates Chris B the new Ward Council for Thamesmead Eas

Thamesmead Tow Directors Surgerie

Broadwaters (Area 1)
Ray Hutchins;
Broadwaters Village Hall.
2nd Saturday 11 am-12 noon

Waterfield (Area 2)
David Irons;
33 Waterfield Close (Home),
Every Monday evening
7.15 pm-9.15 pm. 0181-311 77

Moorings (Area 3)
Ian Savill; Jubilee Centre,
Lytton Strachey Path.
Alternate Thursday evenings
7pm - 8pm.

Manorway (Area 4)
Gerry Bright; 33 Linnet Close.
Thamesmead North (Home).
Telephone: 0181 311 1946

Crossway (Area 5)
Albert Devereux;
7 Longworth Close (Home).
Daily 9am-8pm,
Telephone: 0181 244 9323

Southmere (Area 6)
Katharine Galloway (temporary cover); Binsey Walk, Patch Offic
3rd Saturday of the month 11am-1
Telephone 0181 310 9811

Lesnes (Area 7)
Tina Anderson;
Evenlode House Patch Office
1st Saturday of every month
10am-11pm

Parkview (Area 8)
Katharine Galloway;
32 a/b Maran Way,
Telephone 0181 333 1786.
1st Saturday of the month
10.30am-12.30pm

Greenmead (Area 9)
David Shanks;
Greenmead Clubroom Lime Row,
1st Saturday each month 9am-10a
Telephone: 0181 312 1371
(Before 9.45am)

YOU'VE TRIED THE REST NOW TRY THE BEST

Slimming WORLD

You can lose up to 2 stone in 10 weeks!
So come along and join us and eat yourself slim!

THAMESMEAD CLUBS

TUESDAY'S 7.30 p.m.
St Pauls Church,
Bentham Road
0181 303 1828

WEDNESDAYS 7 p.m
Lime Row,
Thamesmead South
0181 304 0185

WE ARE THE LARGEST GROWING SLIMMING CLUB IN YOUR AREA . . .

The Greycot Press

Printers specialising in quality, competitive printing to the trade and the local community.
For all your business stationery, letterheads, invoices, leaflets, envelopes, booklets and any other printing requirements, contact Brian on
081-311 7273
for a quotation and advice.

Unit 4, Kencot Way,
Thamesmead DA18 4AB.

Thamesmead
BOOT SALES

Thamesmead Town Ltd invites offers for the licence to stage 14 Boot Sales in Southmere Park, Thamesmead South between 1 April 1996 and 31 March 1997. Operators wishing to be considered should contact: The Senior Community Officer, Thamesmead Town Ltd, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South London SE2 9XH. Telephone 0181-310 1500 ext. 358 for further details.

ANNUAL SALE

EXTENDED FOR TWO EXTRA WEEKS

PRICE BLITZ!

PAY THE EASY WAY

UP TO 50% DISCOUNT AVAILABLE

ALL MAKES OF CARPETS AND VINYLS

EXCELLENT VALUE

WHILE STOCKS LAST



UP TO 3 YEARS

INTEREST FREE CREDIT ON SELECTED ITEMS FOR PURCHASES OVER £499

SUBJECT TO STATUS – WRITTEN QUOTATIONS AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

AMERICAN STYLE CUT & LOOP
HESSIAN BACKED
WAS £11.99 0.84 sq.mtr.
NOW £8.99 0.84 sq.mtr.
4 METRES WIDE

SPECIAL OFFER WILTON
FREE FITTING
WAS £17.99 0.84 sq.mtr.
NOW £12.53 0.84 sq.mtr.
4 METRES WIDE

HALF PRICE DEEP AMERICAN SAXONY
TWO COLOURS ONLY
£9.99 0.84 sq.mtr.

SPECIAL PRICE PLAIN TWIST
EXTRA HEAVY WEAR
WAS £15.53 0.84 sq.mtr.
NOW £8.99 0.84 sq.mtr.
4 METRES WIDE

SPECIAL PRICE WILTON RUGS
FURTHER REDUCTIONS
APPROX 6' X 4'
NOW £25 EACH
LIMITED STOCKS

HALF PRICE BERBER CORD
FOAM OR HESSIAN BACKED
WAS £8.34 0.84 sq.mtr.
NOW £4.17 0.84 sq.mtr.

DON'T MISS OUT ON THESE AND MANY OTHER BARGAINS NOW ON OFFER!
AS YOUR LOCAL STORE – WE ALREADY KNOW MOST OF YOUR SIZES

CARPETS & VINYLS FROM STOCK
DELIVERED AND FITTED WITHIN 48 HOURS

FREE ESTIMATES FREE FITTING
ON CARPETS & VINYLS
£8.36 0.84 sq.mtr. or over
FREE LOCAL DELIVERY
ORDERS OVER £35.00

OVER 3000 CARPET PATTERNS
TO CHOOSE FROM
OVER 300 VINYLS
LIMITED STOCK OF NAIRN VINYL ROLLS 3MTRS – SPECIAL PRICES

FREE SHOP AT HOME SERVICE
YOU PHONE US. WE COME TO YOU SAME DAY WITH YOUR REQUIREMENTS

EXPERT FITTING
BY OUR OWN CARPET FITTERS
ONE YEAR GUARANTEE ON ALL OUR FITTING

Thamesmead Carpets



Open Mon-Sat 9am to 5.30pm

Access **0181-311 3666** VISA

Thamesmead

COMMENT



Gregory Lomax Chief Executive

1996 and into the Millennium. The focus is firmly on developing the Thames Gateway, and plans for homes, leisure and business in the area make Thamesmead a vibrant and exciting place for tenants and residents in the boroughs of Greenwich and Bexley to live and work.

Thamesmead has moved on considerably over the last 12 months, with the very obvious new build for sale and rent from companies such as Barratt, Wilcon and Hexagon Housing and the community input and dialogue that is taking place in and around the newly introduced Constituency Meetings.

Thamesmead is buying 25 of the new Barratt properties at Birchmere for rent, and these super new homes are houses with gardens.

RTM, which is such a unique asset for our Town has now joined the Thamesmead staff in Harrow Manor Way, providing an area stretching from Thamesmead to Docklands and Essex with popular music, friendly chat, news and interviews for the locality. You will also hear them when you 'phone us here as they provide the sounds for our telephone waiting time!

Plans for the Town Centre are underway and we are looking forward to seeing a brand new Safeway Foodstore in 1997.

We are negotiating with leisure and fast food companies to draw improved facilities into Thamesmead and developing marketing plans to encourage more industry and therefore more jobs into the area.

With the help of the new Chairman, Elected Board Directors and you, the residents of Thamesmead, we can only go from strength to strength.

I look forward to sharing our successes and visions of the future with you every month in this column and hope you enjoy the ideas and format of your paper The Thamesmead Times.

NATIONAL KNIVES AMNESTY – A HUGE SUCCESS

Plumstead Police Station took stock on how the knives amnesty had worked for them, the results were striking, no less than 60 knives, 5 throwing stars, 3 cut throats and a chisel were handed in.

The message to young people is that it's not macho to carry knives.



The Heron flys over Thamesmead as Dave Irons hoists the new Company Flag

Thamesmead Review

by Dave Irons

"It was a great pleasure for the Board to meet representatives from the Kingsmead Estate, Hackney on Thursday, January 11th. The Board were guests of Kingsmead at the latter part of 1995 so we were delighted to extend an invitation to them to see Thamesmead.

About two and a half years ago the Kingsmead Estate was thought very much a 'no go' area, but the local residents with the Police were anxious to change this situation. In co-operation they slowly turned things around, they got rid of the troublemakers by residents recording and naming the culprits laying the foundation for the Police to take the required action.

Thanks to all their hard work Kingsmead is now clearly an open area for all. This is a typical example of what can be achieved when the Police and the community work together!

Thamesmead entertained the Kingsmead visitors which included their local mayor, showing them around the various areas of Thamesmead. Our Elected Director for Broadwaters, Ray Hutchins took them around his patch, they also visited Crossway, South Thamesmead and the Boilerhouse which serves the town's heating system."

Ron Newman, a director of Kingsmead Community Trust Limited commented: "we very much enjoyed our visit to Thamesmead and would like to thank everybody involved. It certainly showed us what can be achieved by having one company to overview the developments that can be made.

We were very encouraged to have the invitation to meet with the staff and management of RTM, as the Trust is setting up a similar project, their advice was received with grateful thanks.

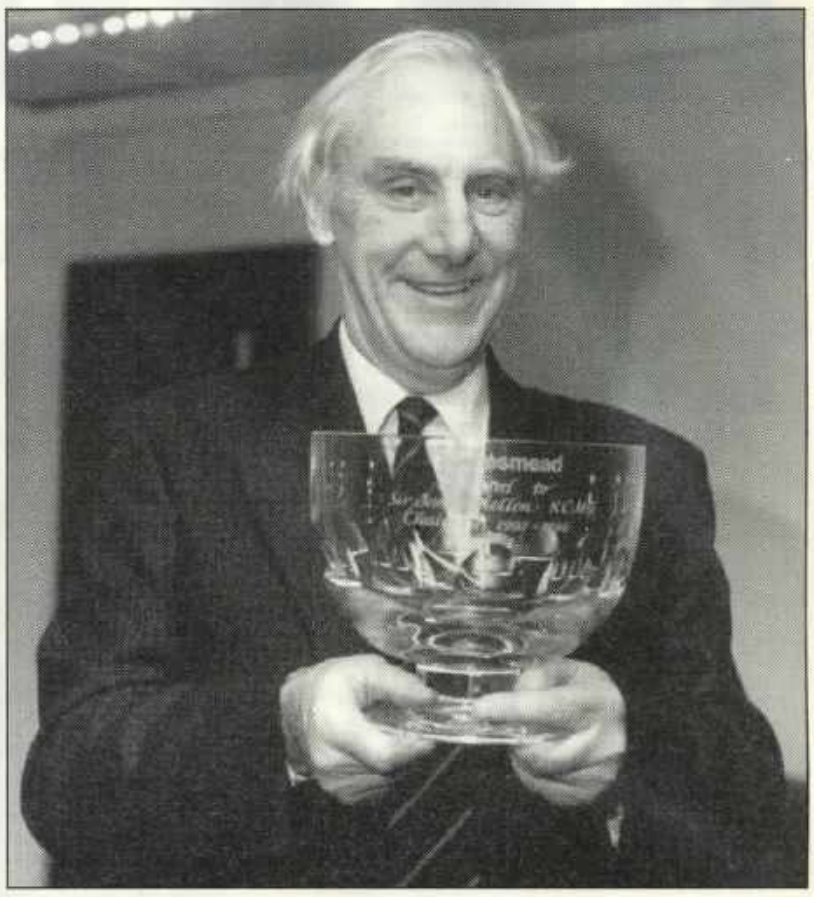
The Trust looks forward to re-visiting Thamesmead on another occasion with the negotiations of Proposed Housing Privatisation for Kingsmead Estate currently being addressed."

The best interests of Thamesmead residents

Soon everyone will be informed of the new Chairman when the final selection is made which will enable me to hand over the additional responsibilities of Acting Chairman which fell to me as Vice Chairman.

I would like to assure residents that I will continue as always to act in the best interests of our community and for the future of Thamesmead.

Thamesmead says Cheerio to Chairman



On Tuesday, January 9, the management and staff of Thamesmead took the opportunity to say cheerio to Sir James Mellon who has been Chairman of Thamesmead Town since 1993.

Sir James who was presented with an engraved cut glass fruit bowl to remind him of his time here, said: "You can't help being proud to have been associated with such dedicated professionals within the Company, I was touched by the presentation party and the kind words."

Alison Marie Catering

ESTABLISHED IN 1984

OUTSIDE CATERERS
A MEMBER OF THE WEDDING GUILD
TOP QUALITY FRESH FOODS
MC IN ATTENDANCE
WEDDINGS, PARTIES, CHRISTENINGS & FUNERALS CATERED FOR
WE SPECIALISE IN BUSINESS FUNCTIONS LARGE OR SMALL

WE BELIEVE THAT ONLY THE BEST IS GOOD ENOUGH FOR OUR CUSTOMERS

TEL: 0181-310 6573
3 Parkway, Thamesmead, Erith DA18 4HG
YOUR LOCAL CATERERS

THAMESMEAD COMMUNITY COLLEGE PARENTS AND FRIENDS ASSOCIATION

Boot Fair

SUNDAY
MARCH 3RD
9am-2pm

SELLERS 8am-BUYERS 9am
CARS £6 in advance £8 on the day
VANS £10 in advance £12 on the day
REFRESHMENTS PROVIDED BY TCC P&FA

0181 473 6090 Sandra Dixon
0181 310 0111 College

Thamesmead in action



•Prompt action by security foils potential crime CCTV came up trumps when Thamesmead Shopping Centre Security Guard saw two men acting suspiciously at the rear of the Mini Town Hall.
Police were called and responded immediately taking the men in for questioning, later releasing them.

Security update... 14 Jan: stolen motorcycle recovered at rear of Dexter House: removed for safe keeping...

NEW security systems are being installed in Buckwheat Court and the Eastern Industrial Estates.



•Everyone welcome to Thamesmead sector police meeting– The next Thamesmead Sector Police Consultative Group meeting will be held at Thamesmead Town offices on 19 March 1996 at 7pm.

•Business update–Hunter Plastics are in the process of redeveloping their new site which will be used for storage.

•Residents welcome club news–The Limestone Club will be under the new management of Messrs Brummitt and Cussack, they plan to re-open the Club in the next two or three months.

•Bedding programme in progress– Thamesmead Landscapes are busy continuing the winter shrub bed programme having completed the areas of Southmere, Lesnes, Parkview and Greenmead. Next on the list are Waterfield, Moorings, Manorway and Crossway.

•Watch out Yogi– Parks, open spaces and waterways are covered seven days a week by the Park Ranger service throughout the winter period.

•Cleaning up– Wettons who provide Thamesmeads cleaning services always have a full schedule. So we thought we'd check out the action!



•Over 62 tons of rubbish was removed over the Christmas period.

•1300 tons of rubbish is removed annually, apart from the usual local authority refuse collections.

•Offensive and racist graffiti is removed within 24 hours of being reported.

•1996 sees stripping and polishing of all lobbies and landings in the 21 tower blocks plus Harold Wilson House.

•Wettons responded immediately by clearing the debris of a gas explosion over Christmas.

•And did you know? 80% of Wettons staff are employed from the Thamesmead area.

•Wettons offer a free service to Senior Citizens and disabled residents of Thamesmead for the removal of large items such as old furniture, fridges and the like.

HERONSGATE PRE-SCHOOL LEARNING ALLIANCE

We have vacancies for 3-5 year olds
Mon–Fri 9.30–11.00

All welcome to our safe and happy group

Penny Ball
0181-473 8629

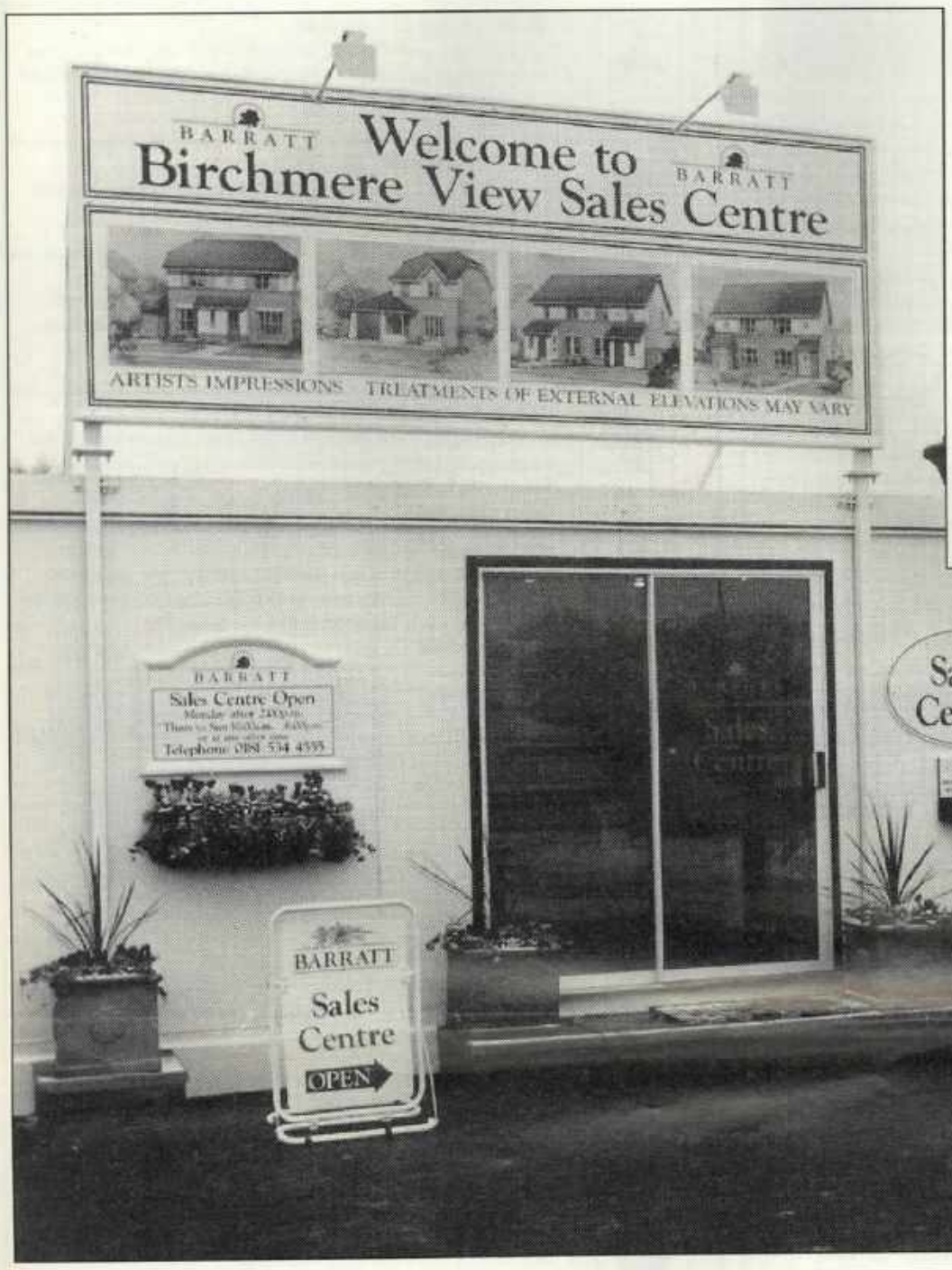
KEMPS PHARMACY

- Toiletries
- Baby clothes
- Perfumery
- Cosmetics

Prescriptions – local collections and deliveries upon request

13 JOYCE DAWSON WAY
THAMESMEAD CENTRAL SE28 8RA

Thamesmead to offer 25 fabulous homes fo rent on new Barratt Lakeside development





Two and Three bedroom houses from the new Barratt Pren Collection, like those now under way on the new Birchmere V development in Thamesmead

Barratt have commenced work on a new development offering houses with gardens that overlook Birchmere, Thamesmead's impressive and picturesque 13 acre lake.

The development will be offering brand new houses which will be starting at under £60,000, all built to designs from the acclaimed new Barratt Premier Collection of cottage-style designs.

Of the 163 houses Thamesmead Town have contracted to purchase 25, Willie Bossert, Head of Developm commented: "This is part Thamesmead's long-term pl for diversifying our hous stock to include new build."

'Birchmere View' foll on the sell-out success neighbouring 'Lakeside P where sales ran consiste ahead of the construct programme, and will be re for occupation in April.

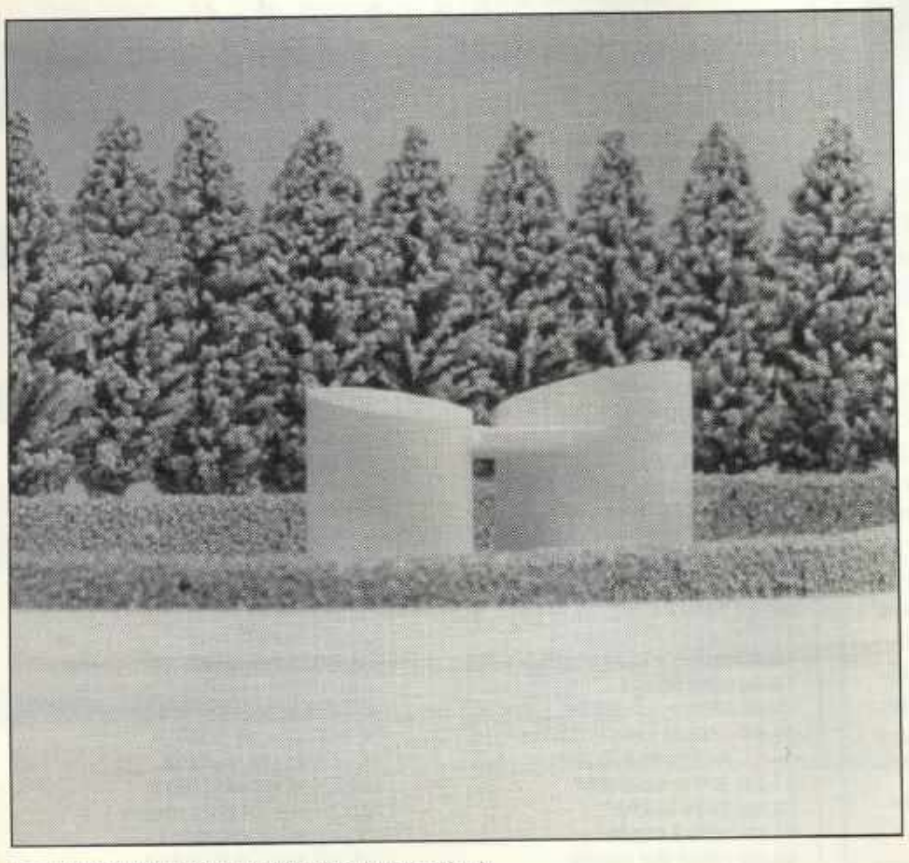
The new sales office is o 7 days a week from 1(to 6pm, telephone num 0181-312 1102.

Thamesmead's first major step in Shopping Centre expansion

Looking like something out of Star Trek, the new foul pumping station is designed to complement and serve the new shopping and leisure facilities planned for Thamesmead.

The station will be stone clad with extensive landscaping using an original and unusual structural form.

Construction will take around 12 months and will be completed before the new Safeway Food Store opens in 1997.



Foul Pumping Station (architects impression)

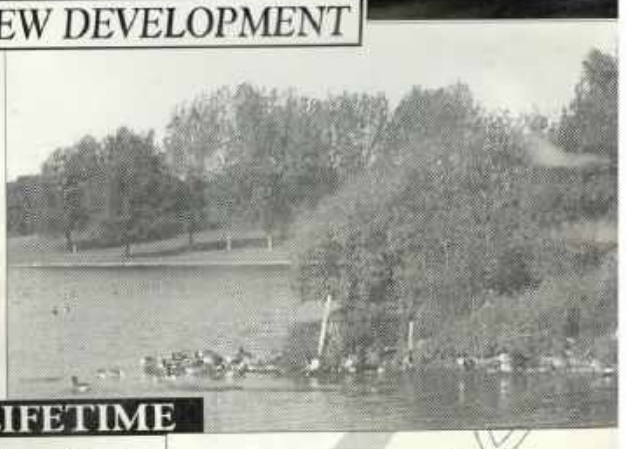
BIRCHMERE VIEW · THAMESMEAD SE28

3 BED HOUSES FROM

£69,995

BRAND NEW DEVELOPMENT

- Award winning, brand new 3 bed houses.
- Set on Birchmere Lake.
- Fitted kitchens with ovens, hobs and hoods.
- Double glazing and gas central heating.
- Many with garages.



PLUS DEAL OF A LIFETIME

100% HOME EXCHANGE – no problems selling or agents fees to pay if you're already a homeowner.

MORTGAGE PAID TILL JAN. '97. Ask for details.

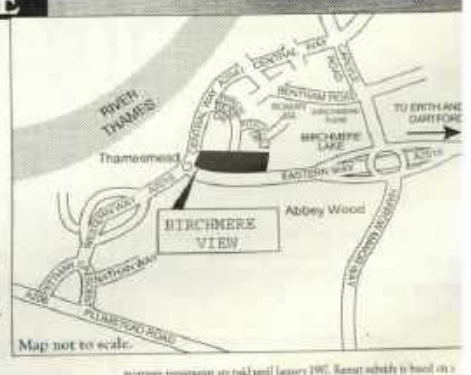
FIRST TIME BUYERS – no deposit move in scheme plus £500 paid towards moving expenses.

Birchmere View, Sales office off junction of Central Way and Eastern Way, Thamesmead SE28.

View our plans for this superb collection of houses now!

Sales office open from 10am to 6pm Thurs to Sun. (Mon 2pm to 6pm).

Tel: 0181 312 1102



Offer available on mortgage up to £50,000 on selected properties and plots, subject to the purchaser taking an approved new mortgage through a Barratt appointed independent financial adviser. Any lender provided cashback or discount will firstly be used to pay mortgage repayments thereafter Barratt will pay a subsidy to ensure mortgage repayments are paid until January 1997. Barratt subsidy is based on a mortgage of 25 years net of tax relief. Offer subject to status, contract and normal Barratt House Exchange conditions. 100% House Exchange available within each operating area only – typically within a 10 mile radius of the development.

BARRATT
Britain's Premier House Builder

BEAVERWOOD LODGE

IN A CLASS OF IT'S OWN

Tuesday Night is
Soul Dance Night

Top Soul Dance D.J.

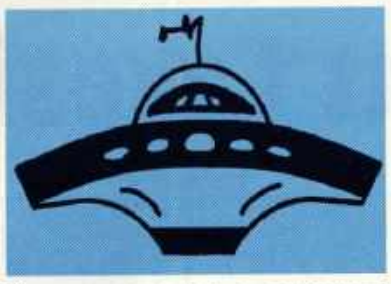
Steve St John

Presents

• Atlantic Soul - Motown •
• Philiadelphia-Jazz Funk •
• Funk-Soul-Reggae-Dance •

Quality Entertainment
Tailored to the Taste
of the sophisticated Over 25's
Doors Open 8.30 pm - 12 Midnight
£4 Entrance fee • Dress to Impress
Beaverwood Lodge, Beaverwood Road,
Chislehurst
Enquires Tel: 0181 301 2509

Something for the X-Files?



Have you ever had a paranormal experience? Do you know someone who has had a meeting with a ghostly or alien being?

Grant E. Charvey is endeavouring to make a documentary about paranormal activities in South East London and he's looking for people to tell their story while being interviewed on camera. Write to Grant at the Thamesmead Times and he will contact you direct.

Ghostwatcher, Tony Wells, has spent many years investigating ghosts and other paranormal activity and will be talking about his experiences at Bostall Library on Tuesday 27 February at 7.30pm.

Tickets are priced at £1.50, which includes refreshments, and are available in advance from the Library in King Harold's Way, Bexleyheath.

This month's stars

by Charity Hope

PISCES–*February 20 - March 20*
You may think that things could not be better, however, you are in for another great month, hold on to your scarf you are heading in the fast lane.
Good day 22nd.

ARIES–*March 21 - April 20*
You may have been feeling unwell but this will soon pass and you can get back into the swing of things. This could be a good month.
Good day: 11th

TAURUS–*April 21 - May 21*
You still haven't managed to slow down but this will happen gradually over the next month.
Good day: 30th

GEMINI–*May 22 - June 22*
Use your time wisely this month, catch up on all those odd little jobs as next month is going to prove busy both in work and socially.
Good day: 14th

CANCER–*June 23 - July 23*
You have had certain hard and fast views that you would not budge on, however, recent events have changed those views. You should feel extremely lucky.
Good day: 2nd

LEO–*July 24 - August 23*
This will be a good month for those looking for a change of direction, either career wise or in your personal life. Write any letters now, you'll be delighted by the response.
Good day: 3rd

VIRGO–*August 24 - September 23*
You will be feeling a lot happier at the moment, family and friends support of your actions, be positive, you will be surprised at what can be achieved.
Good day: 17th

LIBRA–*September 24 - October 23*
You may be feeling a little exasperated at the moment but it will not last. Take a hard look around, you will soon come to recognise just how fortunate you are.
Good day: 31st

SCORPIO–*October 24 - November 22*
Any black clouds that were on your horizon have now passed, you are in for some brighter days. Friends are there for you, out of sight does not mean out of mind.
Good day: 21st

SAGITTARIUS–*November 23 - December 21*
Sometimes we can be so close to someone that we don't actually know them. Take time to get to know that person properly, you will be pleasantly surprised.
Good day: 18th

CAPRICORN–*December 22 - January 20*
This month will seem a lot more settled, you should start to make plans earlier rather than later.
Good day 20th

AQUARIUS–*January 21 - February 19*
You will hear some good news towards the end of the month. This will help on the financial side as well.
Good day: 18th

THAMESMEAD SHOPPING CENTRE

"CHILD OF THE YEAR" PORTRAIT COMPETITION





- Hundreds of £££'s worth of Shopping Vouchers
- Fabulous Deluxe Framed Wallportraits
- Toys and Childrens Clothes
- A Beautiful Trophy for the outright winner
- £2.00 entry fee per child donated to Cancer Research

WILL YOUR CHILD CARRY OFF THE PRESTIGIOUS TROPHY AND BE OUR FIRST WINNER?
TO FIND OUT
ENTER NOW

PLEASE USE CAPITALS:

CHILDS NAME/S

ADDRESS

AGES/S

TEL (DAY)

(EVE)

I would like to enter the Thamesmead Shopping Centre Child of the Year Competition. I agree to donate £2.00 per child to the Cancer Research Campaign when I have my portraits taken.

Name

Signed

Thamesmead Shopping Centre has teamed up with local portrait photographers Ultimate Portraits to bring you the portraits competition that beats them all! Thanks to our sponsors who include Thamesmead Town, Kemps Chemist, Front Page Newsagent, Little Flower Shop and Safeway plc, this is set to be the biggest and most prestigious contest of its kind, ever held in the area, with the first photography session starting at the end of February and culminating in a live presentation to all the winners at the Thamesmere Leisure Centre in April. There are four categories:

Best Baby–Boy or Girl (0-1 year)
Best Girl (1-5 years)
Best Boy (1-5 years)
Children's Group (any age)

To enter simply complete the entry form including the names and ages of your children and post it at the stand provided at Safeway or Kemps Chemist in Thamesmead Shopping Centre. You can use the entry form printed in this paper or collect one from Safeway or Kemps. We will then telephone you to book a portrait sitting at one of the photography sessions to be held at Kemps Chemist during February and March.
A selection of photographs will then be taken. When you return to view your portraits and choose which one to put forward to the judges, a discount package of portraits will be available to purchase. However, no purchase will be necessary to enter the competition. There is a £2.00 entry fee per child which will be donated to Cancer Research

RADIO rtm 103·8 FM

MONDAY - FRIDAY
06.00 RODNEY COLLINS
07.00 JON LUCAS
11.00 DELROY HAYNES
15.00 RAY BRADSHAW
19.00 SAMMY BELL (except Friday)

SATURDAYS
06.00 STEVE PERRY
07.00 KEN MURRAY
08.00 MARK FOX
10.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
14.00 PETER HAYNES
15.00 RTM SPORTS
18.00 MARK FOX
21.00 JON LUCAS
22.00 CLIVE R
01.00 VIETNAMESE PROGRAMME
01.30 STARSOUND

SUNDAYS
07.00 RODNEY COLLINS
09.00 JON LUCAS
13.00 DELROY HAYNES
16.00 SAMMY BELL
18.00 JON LUCAS
19.00 BEAUTIFUL GAME
21.00 ALBUM CHART SHOW – RICHARD WRIGHT
21.30 JOHN KENNEDY
00.00 CLUB SHOW
01.00 AYO BADEJO
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

EVENINGS ON RTM

MONDAYS
21.00 GRUMPY BROWN
00.00 STAR SOUND (BHANGRA SHOW)
03.00 SUPERGOLD

TUESDAY'S
21.00 TONY ANDERSON
22.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
00.30 STAR SOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

WEDNESDAYS
21.00 SAMMY BELL (FOLK)
22.00 TONY MONSON
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

THURSDAYS
21.00 WORD ON THE STREET
22.00 MARK FOX
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

FRIDAYS
19.00 KEN MURRAY
20.00 BRIAN ERINGA
22.00 TONY MONSON
00.00 THE GOSPEL SHOW
01.00 STARSOUND
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

Gerry Bright's Holiday Tips

COSTA DEL SOL THE SUNSHINE COAST

Stretching from Torremolinos to Marbella, this area offers probably the best beaches and watersports to be found in Spain.

The most popular resort for British holidaymakers is without doubt Torremolinos with its easy access from Malaga Airport taking only 20 minutes by coach. The resort offers something for all ages, from beachfront hotels, long sandy beaches and exciting night-life.

You will find plenty of shops, restaurants, cafes and bars, many of them feature live music, flamenco dancing and you wont have to miss your British football matches as there are lots of the usual large screen T.V.'s.

Please allow a full day for a visit to Tivoli World Pleasure Gardens, the kids will love it.

Just down the coast is the resort of Fuengirola which lies between the foot of the mountains and runs along a Palm-Lined Promenade. The resort is normally quieter than Torremolinos but still has an excellent night-life.



Sporting types are well catered for with watersports, tennis and horse riding on offer and you'll find some wonderful golf courses close at hand. Visit the nearby town of Ronda perched on the cliff-tops or pretty Mijas in the mountains behind Fuengirola

Whichever your choice of resort you'll find a variety of foods and menus. If the kids only want fish fingers or Big Mac's you'll find them, but do try the local cuisine its good and inexpensive. Typical costs during 1995 for a three course meal was from £4.50 upwards. Large beer 90p, loaf of bread £1.00, milk 65p litre and soft drinks 50p.

I would recommend a visit to Gibraltar, a full day trip round the island will cost approximately £21.00 and you will find some of the best value duty free shopping in Europe.

Holidays to the Costa Del Sol in 1996 are expected to be extremely popular especially during the school holidays so advised book early.
Next month a report on holidays in the North of England.

The Thamesmead Times takes friends to visit Fire Brigade



Christopher and Robert Ivie together with friend Shane recently visited Woolwich Fire Station at the invitation of Sub Officer George Broad.

The Thamesmead Times had arranged with Sub Officer Broad for the three boys to visit after their mum Barbara telephoned to say how disappointed they had been at missing out on the London's Burning versus The Bill football match in Bromley. She explained how keen they were on the Fire Brigade and ITV's London's Burning.

They were given a 'first class' guided tour by firefighter Alan Quinn who carefully explained all the equipment that may be used in firefighting. The tour was held up slightly as five minutes after their arrival the crew were called out 'on a shout'. Fortunately it was nothing too serious and the men were back within half an hour.

They had their photograph taken with LFF. Kevin Laybourne and Sub Officer George Broad has spoken to the publicity team from London's Burning who will be sending the boys photo's from the series.

Barbara Ivie said "This was a first for Shane he hasn't visited a fire station before, Christopher was delighted because he had remembered a lot from his visit to the Plumstead station two years ago and was praised by Alan, all three had a marvellous time, I think the Fire Brigade do an excellent job, and I would like to thank everyone at the station for taking the time to show us around."

THANKS FOR THE CHRISTMAS PARTY FROM S.A.C.R.A.

In December S.A.C.R.A. (Slocum and Abbotts Close Residence Association) held its Children's Christmas Party.

On behalf of S.A.C.R.A. and all the children who benefited from the kind donations, I would like to thank the Off Licence, chemist, Hairdressers & Spar at the Tavy Bridge shops; Costcutters, the Post Office, Good Friend at Moorings shops Arnott close; Starburger, the Front Page and Safeways at the Town Centre; MacDonalds, The Body Shop In Woolwich; Cadburys Coca Cola Schwepps at Sidcup; The Bob Hope Theatre in Eltham and Hexagon Housing Association for their support and donations without which the party would not have been the success, it was."

AROMATHERAPY FOR ALL

Tina Freeman a qualified aromatherapist will be giving a talk at Thamesmead (Newacres) Library at 7.30pm on Monday 19 February 1996.

Tickets, which include refreshments, cost £1.50 and are available from Thamesmead (Newacres) Library, Binsey Walk, telephone 0181 310 9944.

THE LITTLE FLOWER SHOP
(Opposite the Clock Tower)
Teleflorist
•
flowers for every occasion
•
Remember 17th March
Mothers Day
Tel 0181 312 1151

COMPETITION • COMPETITION • COMPETITION

THE LONDON CLASSIC MOTOR SHOW ALEXANDRA PALACE 16 & 17 MARCH

250 PAIRS OF TICKETS TO BE GIVEN AWAY

(closing date 1 March)

To win one of the 250 pairs of tickets that we have on offer which are valid for Saturday 16 March only, simply answer the following questions and send your answers together with your name and address on a postcard to the address indicated below. The first 250 correct entries picked after the closing date will be sent the tickets.

1. Where in North London is Alexandra Palace?
2. What are the dates of The London Classic Motor Show?
3. What is the British Motor Industry celebrating this year?

Rules: This competition is open to everyone over the age of 18 except employees and families of the Thamesmead Times and Greenwoods's Exhibitions. Competition tickets, worth £6 each, are valid for Saturday 16 March only and are not refundable. Entries must be received in the offices of Greenwood's Exhibitions by Friday 8 March. Winners tickets will be posted on Monday 11 March. No correspondence will be entered into., A list of winners will be available from Greenwood's Exhibitions.

Greenwood's Exhibitions, PO Box 49, Aylesbury, Bucks HP22 5FF.

COMPETITION • COMPETITION • COMPETITION

Ease that conscience with New Body Aerobics

Do you want to get fit but can't bear the thought of going to a class that has mirrors on all sides and the feeling that you are the only one that has never been to a class before?

Well, help is at hand for you and all those that can identify with the above. Local Fitness classes held at convenient times in community centres or church halls are ideal. Catering for local residents who like a class near to their home, where you can wear clothes you feel comfortable in and with the added benefit of no travelling and therefore no parking problems!

The classes are held in Thamesmead at "The Village Hall" Goosander Way Broadwaters North Thamesmead Wednesdays 7-8pm. "Church of the Cross" hall Lensbury Way Thursdays 7.30-8.30pm. In Abbey Wood at "St Michael and all Angels" church hall Abbey Wood Road Tuesday's 7-8pm and Plumstead at "St Marks" Church hall Old Mill Road Plumstead Common Mondays 7.30-8.30pm.

Classes are run by FIONA, a qualified instructor, with 10 years experience in Aerobics, Step and nutrition. She has taught all levels of fitness specialising in and those who have not attended fitness classes for some time.

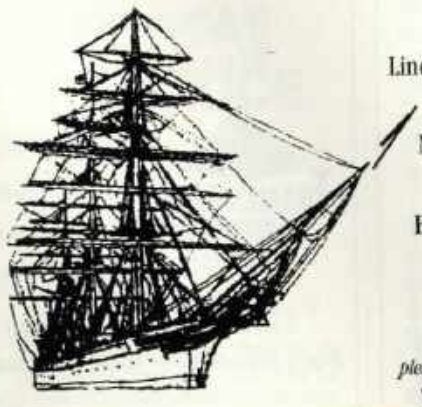
So, now is the time to fulfil that New Year's resolution and ease that conscience. Come along with a friend or make new friends with others who feel the same way as you. For more information or just a chat please ring FIONA on 0181 312 0993.

Thamesmead Library help you to trace your family tree

Sue Highley, a member of the Woolwich and District Local History Society and an expert in family history research, will be giving a talk at Thamesmead (Newacres) Library at 7.30pm on Monday 11 March 1996.

Tickets, which include refreshments, cost £1.50 and are available from Thamesmead (Newacres) Library, Binsey Walk, telephone 0181 310 9944.

WEST END STYLES
Ladies Hair and Beauty Salon
'New' Designer nails/
Nails Art/Charm Nails
Hours: Mon, Tues, and Sat 9am-5pm
Wed 9am-12 noon
Thurs and Fri 9am-7pm
Mon and Tues., Senior Citizens Rate
22 Wilton Road, Abbey Wood, London SE2.
Telephone: 0181-311 3397

THE CUTTY SARK

Located in the Town Centre opposite the Clock Tower.
Linda, Peter and Staff welcome you.
Hot and Cold Food available Monday to Friday Lunchtimes. Cooked and prepared daily
Every Wednesday is Quiz Night.
Weekend Entertainment
Parties welcome
please phone ahead to avoid disappointment
Telephone 0181 310 4998

Thamesmead
Good for Business
Great for Living

Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH.
Tel: 0181-310 1500 Fax: 0181-310 1811



THE HARRIS REPORT

A day to remember for Thamesmead Town

THAMESMEAD TOWN 1
CANVEY ISLAND 2

Sunday 4th February F.A. Vase Fifth Round

A heart breaking 89th minute Canvey Island winner crushed Thamesmead Town's F.A. Vase hopes for another year. However, the result did not sour by far the biggest day in 'Meads' short history.

Fellow Kent leaguers Slade Green hosted this fifth round tie providing the facilities for over 1,000 spectators; an attendance the club could only have dreamed about earlier in the season. The increased vocal support ensured a day that everyone associated with the club will long remember.

After a predictably fast and furious start the away side soon began to stamp their authority onto the match. So it came as a surprise when Dean Burns gave Thamesmead the lead in the 35th minute. He found himself clean through and netted clinically to set up an exciting second period and send the home fans wild.

'Mead' defended with memorable organisation and determination throughout the second half, as Canvey piled on the pressure with chance after chance. As the clock ticked away an upset looked increasingly lightly. That was until the 78th minute when a frustrated Canvey Island went on yet another attack and this time earned themselves a penalty.Andy Jones struck home to bring the scores level.

The winner in the last minute of the match seemed almost inevitable as a tired Thamesmead tried desperately to hold on for extra time. Gary Britnell was the scorer after a vintage Canvey passing move. This marathon F.A. Vase run has earned the club a considerable sum in prize money and some well deserved national publicity.



Fitness through boxing

Thamesmead Boxing club has been giving young people the chance to socialise, keep fit and enjoy friendly but competitive boxing for the past twenty years. Since those early days at St Michael's Church hall, the club, which is run on a voluntary basis, has changed location and grown steadily.

I visited the club at Poplar Place, Thamesmead and spoke to the organiser Keith Moore. On entry I was immediately struck by the friendly atmosphere and impressed with the wide range of facilities. 'Boys and girls are encouraged to the club and we work hard to give everyone an equal opportunity' Keith said.

Session begin with a set of vigorous exercises with the difficulty depending on age and ability. Member are then invited to take advantage of the boxing facilities under the guidance of Keith himself. Full protective equipment is supplied, and under supervision. weights, punch bags and a full size ring are open to all.

'Our aim is to provide our members with a healthy environment where they can train hard under disciplined conditions but most importantly enjoy themselves' explained Keith. Thamesmead Boxing club welcomes new members, male or female between seven and thirty five years of age. Equipment and training is available for all levels of ability. The club's training sessions are held on Monday, Wednesday and Friday evenings from 6.30 until 8.15 p.m. at Poplar Place, Thamesmead.

FISHING IN MID-KENT

MAIDSTONE VICTORY ANGLING & MEDWAY PRESERVATION SOCIETY

Carp to 28lb, Tench 11lb,
Chub to 7lb, Roach to 3lb

STILL WATERS

Mote Park (25 acres), Burham (10 acres), Aldington Lake (8 acres), Wierton Res (5 acres). – **NEW**

AEROBICS AND KEEP-FIT SESSIONS HELD LOCALLY

Tuesday 7pm to 8pm
St Michaels Church Hall,
Abbey Road

Wednesdays 7pm to 8pm
The Village Hall, Goosander Way,

Calling All Young Cricketers

Many budding young cricketers have not yet realised that their chance to take part in league and cup competition is just around the corner.... thanks to Belvedere C.C. The club provides some of the best facilities in the area with sides from primary school to under 16 level, as well as two top senior teams.

The club takes part in friendlies, cups and in the 'A' division of all leagues. Indoor nets are held during the winter at Howbury Grange sports centre, Slade Green. Here members are given the chance to enjoy good practice and expert coaching.

The club passes many promising youngsters onto Kent and London county trials each season. Home games are played at the clubs own ground at Woolwich Road in Belvedere. Away fixtures give members the opportunity to visit some of the most picturesque grounds in Kent, including Bexley, Beckenham and Hayes C.C.

Any 'cricketers to be' who are interested should contact Francis Knott on 01322 445102 for further information.



BOWLED OVER

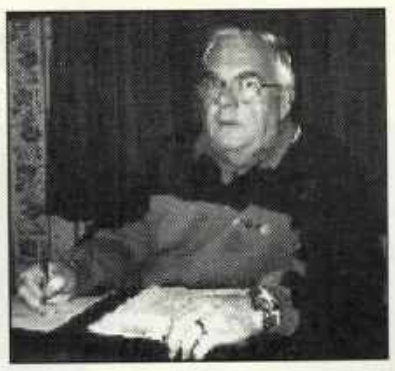
Bowling enthusiasts will be working with Bexley's Leisure Services to improve facilities at West Heath Bowling Green in time for the start of next season.

The West Heath Bowls Consortium, based at West Heath Recreation Ground, Bexleyheath, have raised funds from membership fees and by promoting casual bowling by non members. The money will fund an automatic irrigation system which will improve the quality of the green.

Anyone over 18 is welcome to join Bexley's Bowling Clubs, casual play is available for non members. To find out about your local bowling green telephone Leisure Services on 0181 303 7777, extension 4270.

GREENMEAD U11's

A tough month ahead on paper for the lads who were trying to stay in the top three of the B East division. An away match against Russellers saw an unfortunate 2-0 defeat after scoring an own goal and giving away a penalty. Hextable Harriers came to our Yarnton Way ground the next week and a great game was played in difficult conditions due to bad weather. We went 1-0 down early on but showed a lot of character with Billy Watts scoring his first ever goal to earn us a point. Unbelievable is the only way to describe our match against Villacourt. We completely destroyed and outplayed the visitors but a pat



FISHING THE MEDWAY

by John Perkins.

At this time of Year many Anglers are planning their fishing for next Season and of may be thinking of joining a club. I would like to take this opportunity of putting forward the advantages of clubs who control River venues. If you contact me I can advise you of a club near you. Rivers are of course more demanding of skills when compared with overstocked stillwaters.

I would like to feature the River Medway, specifically Yalding downstream to Maidstone, which is mainly controlled by Maidstone Victory Angling Society. At Yalding, the Tiese and Beult, join the main river. We are lucky in that water from Bewl Reservoir is fed down the



Tiese to top up the system after abstraction just below Maidstone. Starting with the first stretch, namely Yalding to Nettlestead, about one mile in length, and not very wide. Very good fishing can be had here particularly for Bream and Roach, with some good Common Carp and Tench. Next location is Teston Picnic Site, which is run by the KCC. Tickets are sold on the bank at £3:00 per day. At the top of the venue, two to three rod lengths out there is a deep channel, which is very productive all through the Year. Main species are Bream, good Roach, and Common Carp.

Below Te
is excellent
Next, is a l
from Testo
the Woode
This stretcl
of Bream,
Perch (3
Unicumes
River, this
swims are

There is
Lock, belov
free stretch
in Autumn
Roach fishi
many Brea
rural stretc
ductive for
of Maidsto
and Carp.

With re
all stretche
normal m
float, and
works well.
and seed b
including t
pieces of
meat. The
think is loo
with tares
Always be
baits, a go
beating. I

course n
required.
can be ca
some spin

A word
Victory co
Coarse Fi
prohibite
Maidston
by memb
Day Ticke

Please
number b
time, any
fishing p
and I'll d
Contact n

THAMESMERE LEISU

SCHOOLS HALF
SWIMMING PROG

BOTH POOLS CLOSED

LARGE POOL		S
Mats & music	10-11am	
Slide sensation	11-12pm	
Public swimming	12-1pm	P
Rings & things	1-2pm	
Slide sensation	2-3pm	